

Ash Wednesday Ashes

Wearing ashes on our forehead is a tradition of repentance.



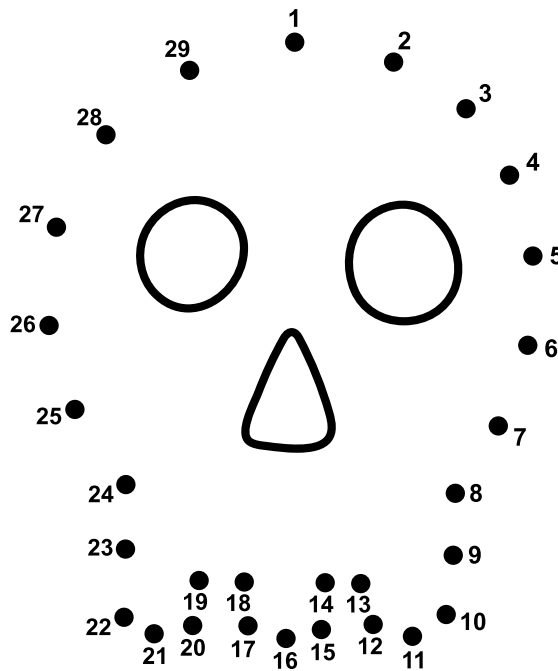
By the sweat of your brow you shall eat bread, Until you return to the ground, from which you were taken; For you are dust, and to dust you shall return.

- Genesis 3:19



Memento Mori

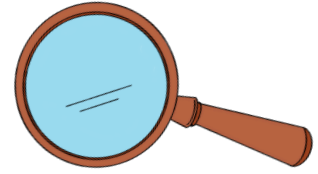
Something we do during Lent and on Ash Wednesday is remember that we will one day die and return to dust. Connect the dots on this skull image to reflect on the importance of living a holy life.



Did You Know?

Catholics are required to fast on Ash Wednesday. We may eat one full meal, or two small meals not equaling more than one regular meal (no meat). We are NOT required to go to Mass on Ash Wednesday, but many do in order to receive the sacramental ashes.

Reflection Questions



Pause to reflect on the season of Lent.

On Ash Wednesday we wear ashes to symbolize our sorrow for sin. How does this outward sign prepare us for Lent?

When someone points out your ashes in public, what is a good way to explain why you have dirt on your forehead?

Response of Confession

Use your reflections to guide a prayer to the Lord.

Lent is a season where we reflect on our sin, our weakness, and our mortality. Take a moment to talk to God about your shortcomings. Ask for his help to avoid sin and grow in virtue. Meditate on his greatness, goodness, and love for us in sending Jesus to free us from sin and death.

Guided Imaginative Prayer

Follow the prompt to enter into imaginative prayer with God.

Imagine you are living in Nineveh during Old Testament times. The prophet Jonah has just announced that in 40 days, the city will be overthrown. Leaders in the town have called everyone to put on sackcloth and ashes over their heads to ask God to spare them this calamity. You think about how awful your people have acted towards one another and towards God. You think about your own sins and how you have offended God. Moved to sorrowful tears over the pain all around you from disorder and evil, you put on an old food bag as a tunic, fall to your knees, scoop the ash from last night's cooking fire and pour them over your head. You spend the day in prayer, fasting from all food, believing in God's mercy.



REFERENCES:

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